ASSAM AGAR TRADERS & AGROIL MANUFACTURERS' ASSOCIATION

Main Road, Hojai - 782435, Assam, India | Reg. No. 664 of 78-79

To,

Shri Himanta Biswa Sarma ji,

Hon'ble Chief Minister of Assam,

Dispur, Guwahati - 781006

Date: 14th January 2023

Respected Sir,

At the outset, Assam Agar Traders and Manufacturers Association (AATMA) deems it a privilege to acknowledge the actions taken by your good self in bringing out the notification of Assam Wood Based Industries (Promotion and Development) Rules 2022 on 12th January 2023.

Assam is the Capital of Agar wood trade since times immemorial. Assam is a natural home to huge population of Agar trees cultivated on private lands which yield superior quality of Agar wood and its derivatives. Besides, there are many Agar wood and Oil processing industries spread across the State which provide market for the agar wood material harvested from Agar plantations and also employment to thousands of skilled workers across the State.

This flourishing trade suffered a major setback due to notification of Assam Wood Based Industries (Establishment & Regulation) Rules 2000. The import of Agar Wood material into Assam further re-export was also stopped in due to certain legal hurdles imposed by the 2000 rules.

AATMA had been persistently pursuing the matter with as many as five successive governments in Assam, as well as Government of India, to bring back the industry in to recovery path, but in vain. As a result, several Agar Wood & Agar Oil manufacturing units have shifted out of Assam in to neighbouring State of Meghalaya impacting the livelihood of thousands of workers who are solely dependent upon this trade.

The path breaking reforms introduced by your good office due to your utmost commitment and dedication to the cause of Agar trade in the State, made the dream come true for Agar growers, Agar wood & Oil manufacturers and traders after 23 long years of waiting and agony.

Assam Wood Based Industries (Promotion and Development) Rules 2022 would give immense boost to the trade and thereby to the lakhs of people of Assam who are directly or indirectly associated with this trade.

AATMA also duly recognises the recent notification of Assam Trees Outside Forest (Sustainable Management) Rules 2022. Assam Wood Based Industries (Promotion and Development) Rules 2022 and Assam Trees Outside Forest (Sustainable Management) Rules 2022 complement and supplement each other and provide favourable ecosystem for complete revival and growth of Agar trade in the State of Assam, benefit the small and marginal farmers, agar wood distillation industry and other traders while providing employment to lakhs of skilled workers who are directly or indirectly engaged in Agar trade. This

showcases your passion towards the welfare of the people and traders dependent upon Agar trade.

While assuring that AATMA will sincerely and committedly take this initiative forward to achieve the desired objective, we heartily welcome this new era in the history of Agar Wood trade.

It is not exaggerating to say that the trade would scale new heights under your kind visionary and dynamic leadership and Assam would rightfully reclaim the lost glory and become the global capital of Agar trade.

AATMA while hereby placing its thankfulness and gratitude on record for bringing out Assam Wood Based Industries (Promotion and Development) Rules 2022, humbly seeks your kind consent to allow the Agar traders to felicitate your good self. In a befitting manner, in a public meeting at Hojai at your kind earliest convenience.

Thanking you,

Yours faithfully,

General Secretary
Assam Agar Traders & Agaroil Manufacturers' Association
Hojai, Assam